

Konstantin Wandel

Doctoral Researcher in Sociology | Computational Social Science

🏛 Faculty of Sociology, Bielefeld University, Universitätsstraße 25, 33615 Bielefeld, Germany

✉ konstantin.wandel@uni-bielefeld.de | 🌐 konstantinwandel.github.io | 📄 KonstantinWandel | 🆔 0009-0007-3321-7774

Research interests Computational social science; multimodal measurement and video as data; measurement validity and annotation design; the German regional press; regional inequality and SOEP panel analysis; political language in parliamentary corpora

POSITIONS

- since 12/2025 **Research Fellow (Wissenschaftlicher Mitarbeiter, predoctoral)**
Social Data Science group (Prof. Dr. Simon Kühne), Faculty of Sociology, Bielefeld University; Leibniz ScienceCampus SOEP-RegioHub, phase 2
Dissertation research; development and operation of the GeoLAB research-data tools.
- 10/2024 – 04/2025 **Research Assistant**
RITZ Regional Innovation and Technology Transfer Centre GmbH
Machine-learning projects for the automotive industry; a local LLM with retrieval-augmented generation for implementing EU regulation in SMEs.
- 09/2023 – 09/2024 **Student Research Assistant**
Center for Political Communication, Zeppelin University
Causal-inference model of how wording in EU legislative texts relates to their adoption.

EDUCATION

- since 09/2026 **PhD in Sociology**
Bielefeld Graduate School in History and Sociology (BGHS), Bielefeld University
Short-Form Video as Data for the Social Sciences: Validated Multimodal Measurement of Online Communication (working title). Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Simon Kühne. Cumulative, four papers: a modality ablation on everyday short-form video; a typology and reporting standard for multimodal coding (with S. Kühne); model choice and annotation budgets under design-based supervised learning; a political stress test on PoliTok-DE.
- 09/2023 – 09/2024 **M.A. Politics, Administration & International Relations (grade 1.2)**
Zeppelin University, Friedrichshafen
Focus: natural language processing, international relations. Thesis: *Epistemicide by Bot: How Generative Media Erodes Consensus Reality*.
- 09/2018 – 03/2023 **B.A. Sociology, Politics and Economics**
Zeppelin University, Friedrichshafen
Thesis: *Politische Partizipation in der Parteiendemokratie: Krise und Chancen entlang des General Incentives Model* (online survey of highly engaged Green Party members).

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

- [1] Kühne, S., Ostermann, K., & Wandel, K. Eating together, eating alike: Household transmission and persistence of plant-based diets in Germany. *Working paper*.
- [2] Wandel, K. Where the news is made: The vertical division of editorial labour and the distribution of originality in the German regional press.
- [3] Wandel, K. A public sphere blind to its cleavages: Ownership, size, and the geography of content sharing in the German regional press.
- [4] Wandel, K. Which constructs live in which modality? A pre-registered modality- and frame-budget ablation for validated multimodal measurement of political short-form video. *Dissertation paper*.

ONGOING COLLABORATIVE PROJECTS

Who speaks for the left-behind? Framing of spatial inequalities in the House of Commons (1988–2019)

With Z. Chen (King's College London) and L. Gawenda

Semantic drift in parliamentary speech

With L. Gawenda

Bundestag speeches 1949–2025 (GermaParl), Jina v4 embeddings, BERTopic.

RESEARCH SOFTWARE AND DATA

2026	Nguyen, H. L., Tsolak, D., & Wandel, K. <i>badata: Regional Job Market Data from the German Federal Employment Agency</i> (R package, v0.2.0). Unemployment, employment and vacancies by district and occupational group, 2012–2025. doi:10.5281/zenodo.7636114
2026	Wandel, K. <i>GeoDB</i> : semantic search over the descriptions of German georeferenced data, more than 11,000 records from over 35 sources, each linked to the portal that holds the data. geodb.geolab.soz.uni-bielefeld.de, doi:10.5281/zenodo.21134145
2026	Wandel, K. <i>SOEP Variable Finder</i> : multilingual semantic search over 125,496 variables of the official SOEP-Core v41 metadata. soep-faiss.geolab.soz.uni-bielefeld.de, doi:10.5281/zenodo.21134306
2026	Wandel, K. <i>Parliamentary Speech Finder</i> : retrieval over Bundestag speeches 1949–2025 (research prototype). doi:10.5281/zenodo.21194707

TALKS

10/2026	Video, images and text as data: Navigating a new frontier <i>LSC Research Retreat, Leibniz ScienceCampus SOEP-RegioHub, Bielefeld, 6–7 October 2026</i>
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RESEARCH INFRASTRUCTURE AND SERVICE

since 2026	GeoLAB, SOEP-RegioHub Rebuilt the project website (geolab.soz.uni-bielefeld.de); develops and maintains the three search tools above; prepared a licensed corpus of 62.7 million regional newspaper articles (2013–2024) for research use, with near-duplicate tiers and semantic search.
2026	Coding team Codebook, annotation app and calibration rounds for two student research assistants.
2026	Advising Methods and data advice for an MA thesis at Bielefeld University on the deservingness of the unemployed in Bundestag debates.
2026	Corpus verification Independent check of a House of Commons speech corpus, 1919–2026 (47,651 rows), for a collaborator at King’s College London.

METHODS AND SKILLS

Methods	Panel data analysis (fixed effects, Mundlak/CRE, event studies, RI-CLPM), survey data and weighting, gravity and network models, measurement validation and inter-coder reliability, text as data (embeddings, topic models, near-duplicate detection), multimodal annotation with vision-language models
Software	R (fixest, survey, lavaan, modelsummary), Python (sentence-transformers, BERTopic, FAISS, vLLM), SQL (DuckDB), TeX Git, Linux
Languages	German (native), English (C2)

REFERENCES

Available on request.